scoup.ai

scoup.ai market research

2026-10-18

> **Pre-product. Synthetic data only. Not investment advice.**

Documents in this volume:

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01 Competitors

Status: pre-product. The product, scoup.ai, runs on synthetic data only, has never been deployed and has no paying customers. Every "why we can beat them" line below is a hypothesis about positioning, not a measured result.

Research date: 2026-10-17. All URLs were accessed on that date unless an entry says otherwise. Where a vendor page was rendered by a fetch tool rather than read as raw HTML, the figure is marked "(vendor page)" and should be treated as the vendor's own claim. Pricing is "not public" wherever we found no published price; we did not estimate any.

How we chose the set

In one workflow, scoup.ai does five things: it assembles detention and accessorial evidence packets and demand letters for trucking, audits ocean demurrage and detention (D&D) invoices, scores carrier charges, gives a fuel-surcharge outlook, and routes every outgoing claim through a four-eyes approval step. No single competitor covers that combination, so the set has three groups. Six are freight audit and payment (FAP) firms that a mid-market shipper would compare us against: Loop, Cass, Trax, CTSI-Global, nVision Global and Intelligent Audit. One is an ocean D&D specialist that audits and disputes container fees: BlueCargo. Two are carrier-side detention tools that track dwell time from ELD geofences and create claims: Hey Bubba and FleetOptos.

We checked the names suggested in the brief. Cass, Trax, CTSI-Global, nVision Global and Loop are real and relevant. Portcast is real, but its public material describes a container visibility and ETA platform with a D&D invoice module, and we could not confirm pricing, customers or dispute volumes, so it sits in the adjacent list rather than the core set. Kpler is a commodity and maritime data company; we found no evidence it sells D&D invoice auditing, so we dropped it. "Fenix Parcel" could not be matched to a verifiable company; parcel refund auditors are outside our wedge in any case.

The market-analysis file in the main checkout says its competitor descriptions were "characterizations from general knowledge" and not verified. This file replaces those characterizations with sourced entries. Two repo statements changed on re-verification: Loop's funding is now known ($160M total, where the repo said "not verified"), and Intelligent Audit charges a subscription, not audit fees (its own FAQ says so).

Loop

- URL: https://www.loop.com/
- Founded / HQ: 2021, San Francisco, CA. CEO Matt McKinney. Source: Sacra, Loop company profile, https://sacra.com/c/loop, accessed 2026-10-17
- Funding raised (source, date): $160M total. Series A $30M (2022), Series B $35M (October 2023), Series C $95M (17 April 2026, led by Valor Equity Partners and the Valor Atreides AI Fund). Loop also acquired Data2Logistics and StrategIQ Commerce in 2025. Source: Business Wire, "Breakthrough Transportation Logistics Startup Loop Announces $35 Million Series B", https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20231003388240/en/, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: AlphaMaven, "Loop raises $95M Series C", https://alpha-maven.com/story/venture-capital/loop-raises-95m-series-c, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Sacra, Loop company profile, https://sacra.com/c/loop, accessed 2026-10-17
- Pricing tiers: not public. https://loop.com/pricing returned HTTP 404 on 2026-10-17. Sacra describes the model as "platform fees with usage- or volume-based components tied to invoice count, shipment volume, and modules adopted" (analyst inference, not a published price). Source: Sacra, Loop company profile, https://sacra.com/c/loop, accessed 2026-10-17

- Target segment: enterprise shippers, 3PLs, brokers and forwarders. Named customers on its home page include Michael Kors, Under Armour, General Mills, Macy's, J.Crew, Great Dane, Kendra Scott and GILLIG; Sacra adds Dell and Estee Lauder. Sacra estimates $44M annualized revenue in March 2026 (analyst estimate, grade C). Source: Loop, home page, https://www.loop.com/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Core capabilities (from their own marketing): freight audit, carrier payments, parcel contract intelligence, decision intelligence and analytics, real-time shipment visibility, cost allocation and claim processing (vendor page). The home page does not name detention, accessorial disputes or ocean D&D as distinct products. Source: Loop, home page, https://www.loop.com/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Documented weaknesses: we found no public user complaints. Gartner Peer Insights lists 2 reviews at 4.5 stars, too few to say anything. A competitor-authored comparison (ShipScience, which sells a parcel claims product) calls Loop "young" and notes its parcel team was "hired in late 2025"; treat that as a rival's marketing. Source: Gartner Peer Insights, Loop Logistics Data Platform, https://www.gartner.com/reviews/product/loop-logistics-data-platform, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: ShipScience, "Intelligent Audit vs. Loop", https://www.shipscience.com/intelligent-audit-vs-loop-enterprise-freight-parcel-audit-comparison-2026/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Mid-market fit (added 2026-10-17): moving toward it by acquisition. Loop merged with Data2Logistics on 18 August 2025; Data2Logistics, founded in 1964 and based in Fort Myers, FL, ran freight audit and payment for clients described in a CB Insights summary as ranging "from large to small and medium-sized businesses" (search summary; we did not open the CB Insights page). FreightWaves reports implementation times "measured in weeks, sometimes as fast as 31 days, depending on the modules". No mid-market price is published. For the shipper-first strategy Loop is the most direct threat, because it now owns a mid-market book and the capital to automate it. Source: FreightWaves, "Loop and Data2Logistics merge to unlock profit in the supply chain", https://www.freightwaves.com/news/loop-and-data2logistics-merge-to-unlock-profit-in-the-supply-chain, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Loop, "Loop + Data2Logistics: Unlocking the next era of supply chain intelligence", https://www.loop.com/article/loop-data2logistics-unlocking-the-next-era-of-supply-chain-intelligence, accessed 2026-10-17
- Why we can beat them: we probably cannot beat Loop on enterprise audit; it has $160M and an installed base. Our case rests on the segment its acquisition playbook skips: carriers with 5 to 100 power units, which Loop does not serve at all, and mid-market shippers who need an evidence packet per disputed accessorial rather than a reconciled invoice feed. Loop is also the company most likely to close this gap, which makes it the main competitive risk in this file.

Cass Information Systems

- URL: https://cassinfo.com/
- Founded / HQ: founded 1906, St. Louis, MO. Public on Nasdaq (CASS); owns Cass Commercial Bank. Source: Cass Information Systems, Form 8-K exhibit 99.1 (Q3 2025 results), https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/708781/000070878125000103/cass-20250930xexx991.htm, accessed 2026-10-17
- Funding raised (source, date): public company, not venture funded. Total revenues of about $50.1M in Q3 2025; $2.5B total assets. Source: same 8-K exhibit, accessed 2026-10-17
- Pricing tiers: not public. The freight audit page shows no prices. Source: Cass, Freight Audit and Payment, https://cassinfo.com/freight-audit-payment, accessed 2026-10-17
- Target segment: large shippers. Logos on the page include Emerson, Volvo, PepsiCo, Unilever, Toyota and Macy's. Transportation dollar volume was $8.6B (Q1), $9.4B (Q2), $9.3B (Q3) and $9.2B (Q4) in 2025, which sums to $36.5B for the year (our arithmetic: 8.6 + 9.4 + 9.3 + 9.2). Q3 2025 invoice volume was 8.9 million. Source: Cass, Form 8-K exhibits for Q2 and Q3 2025, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/708781/000070878125000078/cass-20250630xexx991.htm and https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/708781/000070878125000103/cass-20250930xexx991.htm, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Barchart, "Cass Information Systems reports third quarter 2025 results", https://www.barchart.com/story/news/35633125/cass-information-

systems-reports-third-quarter-2025-results, accessed 2026-10-17 (the Q4 2025 Business Wire release returned HTTP 403; Q1 and Q4 figures come from search-indexed copies of the releases and should be re-read from EDGAR)

- Core capabilities (from their own marketing): freight audit, freight payment, freight accounting, freight invoice management, business intelligence, freight benchmarking, parcel spend management (vendor page). The page does not mention disputes, claims, detention or ocean D&D. Source: Cass, Freight Audit and Payment, https://cassinfo.com/freight-audit-payment, accessed 2026-10-17
- Documented weaknesses: no public user complaints found. Gartner Peer Insights shows 1 review (5 stars). Source: Gartner Peer Insights, Cass Freight Audit and Payment Services, https://www.gartner.com/reviews/product/cass-information-systems-freight-audit-and-payment-services, accessed 2026-10-17
- Mid-market fit (added 2026-10-17): we found no published small or mid-market offer, minimum spend or price. Its page logos are Fortune 500 names, and its model rests on payment processing at volume. We could not confirm the industry rule of thumb, repeated in search summaries, that outsourced freight audit pays off from about $500K or $10M of annual freight spend, so we do not use it.
- Why we can beat them: Cass earns from payment float and processing at enterprise scale. A carrier chasing a $200 detention charge, or a shipper disputing one lumper fee, is not the unit Cass is built around. We would not compete for Cass's payment business; we would sit next to it as the dispute layer.

Trax Technologies

- URL: https://www.traxtech.com/
- Founded / HQ: HQ at 909 Lake Carolyn Parkway, Irving, TX. Founding year: UNKNOWN — needs primary research (not stated on the pages we reached). Source: Trax, AI Vision and Roadmap, https://www.traxtech.com/products/ai-vision-and-roadmap, accessed 2026-10-17
- Funding raised (source, date): backed by Strattam Capital and Spire Capital; debt financing from Accel-KKR Credit Partners (amount not disclosed). Acquired EM6, a European freight audit provider, in November 2025. Launched an AI product called Prizma in August 2025. Source: Trax, "Trax Technologies funds growth with Accel-KKR growth financing", https://www.traxtech.com/news/trax-technologies-funds-growth-with-accel-kkr-growth-financing, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Trax, "AI-powered freight audit year in review", https://www.traxtech.com/blog/ai-powered-freight-audit-year-in-review, accessed 2026-10-17
- Pricing tiers: not public.
- Target segment: "organizations with globally complex supply chains" (vendor page). Source: Trax, AI Vision and Roadmap, https://www.traxtech.com/products/ai-vision-and-roadmap, accessed 2026-10-17
- Core capabilities (from their own marketing): global freight audit and spend management; its blog says the audit catches duplicate invoices and "missing or incorrect accessorial fees". The roadmap page lists "Invoice-Contract Intelligence" and "Autonomous Decision-Making" as AI directions rather than shipped features. Source: Trax, "Traditional Freight Audit vs. Trax Global Freight Audit", https://traxtech.com/blog/traditional-freight-audit-vs-trax-freight-audit, accessed 2026-10-17
- Documented weaknesses: no public user complaints found in the sources we searched.
- Mid-market fit (added 2026-10-17): no small or mid-market offer, minimum or price found. Its stated focus remains "organizations with globally complex supply chains", and its 2025 moves (Prizma, the EM6 acquisition in Europe) point up-market and abroad rather than down-market.
- Why we can beat them: Trax is buying audit volume in Europe and selling to multinationals. A 30-truck carrier is not a Trax customer, and a shipper with $20M of freight spend sits below its stated focus on "globally complex" networks (inference from its positioning, not a published threshold).

CTSI-Global

- URL: https://ctsi-global.com/
- Founded / HQ: traces to Continental Traffic Service, Inc. (1957); acquired by J. Kenneth Hazen in 1982; world HQ in Memphis, TN. Source: CTSI-Global, "CTSI-Global Unveils New Logistics Tech World Headquarters in Memphis", https://ctsi-global.com/2020/ctsi-global-unveils-new-logistics-tech-world-headquarters-in-memphis/, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Wikipedia, CTSI-Global, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/CTSI-Global, accessed 2026-10-17
- Funding raised (source, date): privately held; calls itself the "largest privately held freight bill audit and payment services provider" (company press release, 2017). No outside funding found. Source: CTSI-Global, press release, https://ctsi-global.com/2017/largest-privately-held-freight-audit-and-payment-services-provider/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Pricing tiers: not public.
- Target segment: large enterprises with distribution networks (inferred from the home page).
- Core capabilities (from their own marketing): freight audit and payment, parcel spend management, Honeybee TMS, supply chain intelligence, strategic data, logistics management (vendor page). Detention, D&D and disputes are not named. Source: CTSI-Global, home page, https://ctsi-global.com/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Documented weaknesses: no public user complaints found. Wikipedia reports a headcount of roughly 220 (150 US, 60 India, 6 Ireland, 6 China), about the same as in 1999, which points to a services firm whose capacity grows with analysts rather than software. Source: Wikipedia, CTSI-Global, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/CTSI-Global, accessed 2026-10-17
- Mid-market fit (added 2026-10-17): no small or mid-market offer, minimum or price found. The home page stresses "personalized focus", which fits a services model; with a headcount near 220, each additional small account costs analyst time.
- Why we can beat them: a services-led model with a fixed analyst team prices out small accounts. An agent that drafts the packet and leaves the send decision to a person could change the unit cost of a small dispute. That stays a claim until we measure cost per claim in pilots.

nVision Global

- URL: https://corporate.nvisionglobal.com/
- Founded / HQ: founded 1992 as a local claims processing company; HQ in the Atlanta area (1900 Brannan Road, McDonough, GA). Source: nVision Global, About Us, https://corporate.nvisionglobal.com/about-us/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Funding raised (source, date): no outside funding found; privately held.
- Pricing tiers: not public.
- Target segment: shippers with multi-modal networks. The company states it manages more than $7.3B of annual freight spend and processes more than 182 million shipment transactions a year (vendor page). Source: nVision Global, Facts and Figures, https://corporate.nvisionglobal.com/freight-audit-corporate/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Core capabilities (from their own marketing): freight audit and payment, TMS, freight claims (cargo loss and damage), freight spend analytics. Its blog explains D&D invoice auditing as checking free time and daily rates against the service agreement. Source: nVision Global, "Freight Invoice Audit: Understanding Demurrage and Detention Fees", https://corporate.nvisionglobal.com/freight-invoice-audit-understanding-demurrage-and-detention-fees/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Documented weaknesses: no public user complaints found.
- Mid-market fit (added 2026-10-17): its bundle of TMS, freight audit and payment and freight claims is the kind of package a mid-size shipper without its own TMS might buy. We found trade-press mentions of mid-size customers but could not open the articles (Inbound Logistics returned no readable text), so we record mid-market fit as plausible, not confirmed. No price or minimum found.

- Why we can beat them: nVision's claims heritage is cargo loss and damage, a different evidence problem from timestamp-based detention, and it does not sell to carriers. We would differ on the carrier side and on producing a cited demand letter rather than an audit exception.

Intelligent Audit

- URL: https://www.intelligentaudit.com/
- Founded / HQ: founded 1996; 365 West Passaic Street, Rochelle Park, NJ. CEO Hannah Testani. Source: Intelligent Audit, FAQ, https://www.intelligentaudit.com/faq, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: ShipScience, "Intelligent Audit vs. Loop", https://www.shipscience.com/intelligent-audit-vs-loop-enterprise-freight-parcel-audit-comparison-2026/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Funding raised (source, date): no venture funding found; described as organically grown by a competitor-authored source, so treat with care.
- Pricing tiers: no prices published. The FAQ states, verbatim: "Intelligent Audit's pricing model reflects a subscription model based on annual shipment volume, modes, and # of carriers." For companies shipping under $10M a year it offers Catalyst, with "a free trial for 90 days" followed by "one of our three Catalyst plans" (plan prices not published). Catalyst launched in June 2025 for parcel spend. Source: Intelligent Audit, FAQ, https://www.intelligentaudit.com/faq, accessed 2026-10-17
- Target segment: enterprise shippers in all modes; Catalyst targets businesses with $15M to $150M revenue (parcel).
- Core capabilities (from their own marketing): multimodal audit covering "parcel, LTL, truckload, ocean, air, international, and intermodal"; it "reviews accessorial charges"; it publishes a case study on reducing D&D costs through invoice validation. Source: Intelligent Audit, FAQ, https://www.intelligentaudit.com/faq, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Intelligent Audit, case study, https://www.intelligentaudit.com/case-studies/reducing-demurrage-and-detention-costs-through-invoice-validation, accessed 2026-10-17
- Documented weaknesses: no public user complaints found. A competitor (ShipScience) says it has "no parcel claims automation"; that is a rival's claim.
- Mid-market fit (added 2026-10-17): the only incumbent with a published down-market product, but it is parcel. The Catalyst page offers a "Free 90-day trial", calls itself "Simple. Quick. Affordable.", and lists "Automated parcel audit with direct carrier integrations" as its first feature; it speaks to "Smaller teams without the time or resources" (raw page text). The FAQ sends companies "shipping under $10M" a year to Catalyst. We found nothing in Catalyst about truckload accessorials, detention or ocean D&D. If Intelligent Audit extends Catalyst to freight accessorials, it becomes the closest competitor for mid-market shippers. Source: Intelligent Audit, Catalyst for SMBs, https://www.intelligentaudit.com/products/catalyst-for-smbs, accessed 2026-10-17
- Why we can beat them: Intelligent Audit is the incumbent moving down-market most actively, which makes it a real threat in the shipper segment. It still sells audit and visibility to shippers only and offers nothing to the carrier who is owed the money.

BlueCargo

- URL: https://www.bluecargo.io/
- Founded / HQ: founded 2018 by Alexandra Griffon and Laura Theveniau; address on site 440 N Barranca Ave #6606, Covina, CA. Source: BlueCargo, home page, https://www.bluecargo.io/home-tests, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: YesPress, BlueCargo profile, https://yespress.io/bluecargo, accessed 2026-10-17
- Funding raised (source, date): $11M round led by Soma Capital and Left Lane Capital (2023). Source: FreightWaves, "BlueCargo raises $11M to bring visibility to drayage fees", https://www.freightwaves.com/news/bluecargo-raises-11m-to-bring-visibility-to-drayage-fees, accessed 2026-10-17
- Pricing tiers: not public.

- Target segment: shippers, logistics service providers, drayage carriers and brokers at US container ports. Named customers include GE Appliances, Samsung, Flexport, Cargomatic, J.B. Hunt and Knight Transportation (vendor page).
- Core capabilities (from their own marketing): freight audit and pay, "Dispute resolution with evidence-backed documentation", real-time charge validation, and invoice checks against OSRA invoice requirements. Claimed results, verbatim from the raw page: "$350M+ in Detention & Demurrage Savings", "99% Invoice Automation", "95% Dispute Success", "230+ Terminals & Rail Ramps Connections" (vendor claims, grade C). Source: BlueCargo, home page, https://www.bluecargo.io/home-tests, accessed 2026-10-17
- Documented weaknesses: no public user complaints found.
- SME importer fit (added 2026-10-17): the page leads with "1 in 5 Top US Shippers" and "Real Value in 4 Weeks"; named customers are large shippers and drayage carriers. We found no SME plan or price. For SME importers BlueCargo is the benchmark product, but its go-to-market as published is enterprise.
- Why we can beat them: BlueCargo is the strongest competitor for the ocean D&D module and we should not pretend otherwise. Its focus is port and drayage data. Our angle is narrower: one evidence and approval workflow that covers both a truck's detention claim and the container's D&D invoice for the same importer. Whether importers want those combined is untested.

Hey Bubba (Bubba AI)

- URL: https://bubba.ai/solutions/detention-management
- Founded / HQ: founder and CEO Tapan Chaudhari, previously founder of TruckX. Founding year and HQ: UNKNOWN — needs primary research (the site phone number has a 775 Nevada area code; we did not confirm an office). Source: FreightWaves, "Autonomous dispatcher Bubba AI launches for independent truckers, small carriers", 25 March 2025, https://www.freightwaves.com/news/autonomous-dispatcher-bubba-ai-launches-for-independent-truckers-small-carriers, accessed 2026-10-17
- Funding raised: not disclosed.
- Pricing tiers: not public. https://bubba.ai/pricing returned HTTP 404; the detention page offers a free trial and a demo. At launch the company offered three months of free access to users signing up with a DOT-registered email. Source: FreightWaves, same article, accessed 2026-10-17
- Target segment: owner-operators, small fleets (2 to 10 trucks) and fleets of 11 or more (vendor page).
- Core capabilities (from their own marketing): records dwell time from ELD geofence crossings, captures detention terms at booking, logs the claim with timestamps attached and notifies the broker while the truck is still at the facility; connects to "100+ ELDs, including Samsara, Motive, Geotab, Trimble and TruckX" (vendor page). The core product is an AI voice dispatcher that books loads. Source: Hey Bubba, Detention Management, https://bubba.ai/solutions/detention-management, accessed 2026-10-17
- Documented weaknesses: no user reviews found.
- Why we can beat them: Hey Bubba captures the clock. Its public page does not describe assembling the rate-confirmation clause, BOL times, lumper receipt and calculation into a cited packet, tracking a dispute deadline, or serving the shipper side. A carrier already on Hey Bubba is a possible integration partner rather than a lost deal.

FleetOptos (Calcutiv LLC)

- URL: https://marketplace.geotab.com/solutions/fleetoptos/
- Founded / HQ: publisher Calcutiv LLC (https://calcutiv.com/). Founding year and HQ: UNKNOWN — needs primary research.
- Funding raised: not disclosed.

- Pricing tiers: not public; the Geotab Marketplace listing shows tier "Basic" with no visible price. Source: Geotab Marketplace, FleetOptos listing, https://marketplace.geotab.com/solutions/fleetoptos/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Target segment: trucking fleets running Geotab telematics in the US and Canada.
- Core capabilities (from their own marketing, raw listing text): "FleetOptos Detention Tracker automates detention billing for trucking fleets using Geotab telematics data"; it tracks geofence dwell time and "applies contract-specific billing rules (free time allowances, hourly rates)".
- Documented weaknesses: 0 reviews on the marketplace listing, and the product depends on a single telematics vendor.
- Why we can beat them: single-ELD dependence, and billing recommendations that stop short of evidence assembly, dispute tracking and approval controls.

Adjacent, not profiled in full

These companies touch our workflow but did not meet the bar for a full row, either because their core product is something else or because we could not verify enough this session.

- Portcast (Singapore): container visibility platform with a D&D invoice module. Its home page (raw text) says it can "Extract invoice data with 99% accuracy", "Catch and flag undue costs before you get billed" and "Enable touchless processing from flag to resolution", and it addresses shippers and forwarders. It also publishes a free carrier-by-carrier D&D rate tool (https://www.portcast.io/dd-tool/maersk-demurrage-and-detention), a low-cost entry point for smaller importers. Raised a $6.5M Series A on 18 November 2024, anchored by Susquehanna Asia VC. Its pricing page returned HTTP 404. SME fit: plausible through the free tool; no SME plan or price found. Source: Portcast, home page, https://www.portcast.io/, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: DealStreetAsia, "Logistics tech startup Portcast raises $6.5m in Series A funding", https://media.dealstreetasia.com/stories/portcast-series-a-funding-419951, accessed 2026-10-17
- Detention Source: iOS app that detects geofence arrival and departure and, per its listing, "autonomously invoices and processes detention requests". No company details verified. Source: Apple App Store, Detention Source, https://apps.apple.com/ca/app/detention-source/id6444958697, accessed 2026-10-17
- GeoStamp by WiseTech Global: geofence timestamping on the Motive marketplace. A timestamp source, not a claims product. Source: Motive Marketplace, GeoStamp, https://marketplace.gomotive.com/app/geostamp-by-wisetech-global, accessed 2026-10-17
- project44, FourKites and TMS-embedded audit (Oracle, Blue Yonder, MercuryGate): carried over from the repo's market analysis as adjacent players. Not re-verified this session; listed in open-questions.md.

Forwarders and customs brokers as D&D substitutes (added 2026-10-17)

An SME importer’s first stop for a D&D dispute is usually its forwarder or customs broker, so we looked for priced D&D recovery services from them. We found dispute intake and guidance, not a recovery product. CastleGate Forwarding states that D&D disputes "(or requests for fee mitigation, refund or waiver) for U.S. shipments must be raised by entering a ticket through our website in Partner Home". A search summary describes a DHL Global Forwarding "Disputes Resolution Team" for D&D mitigation, refunds and waivers; the DHL PDF did not return readable text, so this is unconfirmed. Mohawk Global, a customs broker, publishes a guide on how to dispute D&D charges. Source: CastleGate Forwarding, Regulatory, https://castlegateforwarding.com/resources/regulatory, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: DHL Global Forwarding, FMC D&D mitigation (PDF), https://dhl.com/content/dam/dhl/local/us/dhl-global-

forwarding/documents/pdf/us-dgf-fmc-dds-mitigation.pdf, attempted 2026-10-17, text not readable Source: Mohawk Global, "How to dispute detention and demurrage charges", https://mohawkglobal.com/trade-translation/how-to-dispute-detention-and-demurrage-charges/, accessed 2026-10-17

Two points follow. First, when the forwarder acts as an NVOCC it is itself the billing party, so its dispute desk handles complaints against its own invoices; an independent checker has no such conflict. Second, forwarders and customs brokers already hold the importer relationship and the documents, which makes them a possible channel as much as a substitute. We found no forwarder or broker publishing a fee for D&D recovery; that is a search result, not proof that none exists.

What the set tells us

The pattern holds across the shipper-side firms we could read. They audit invoices against contract rates, pay carriers and report spend. Their pages say little or nothing about building a counterparty-ready dispute for a single accessorial, and none of them sells to carriers. The carrier-side tools capture geofence time and stop at the claim line. BlueCargo is the only firm in the set that markets evidence-backed dispute resolution with a stated success rate, and it does so only for port D&D.

That leaves the gap scoup.ai was designed for: one evidence, deadline and approval workflow that works both for the party owed the money and for the party asked to pay it. The gap is visible on paper. Whether buyers will pay for it is what the design-partner phase has to measure, and the two firms most able to close it from above are Loop (capital) and Intelligent Audit (already moving down-market).

02 Buyer segments

Status: pre-product. The product, scoup.ai, uses synthetic data only, never deployed, no paying customers. The revenue ceilings below are arithmetic on stated inputs. Every input is labelled SOURCED (with a source line) or ASSUMED (our number, untested). No ceiling here has been validated by a customer.

Research date: 2026-10-17.

Strategy (owner decision, 2026-10-17): shipper- and importer-first. Mid-market shippers and SME ocean importers are the core segments; small and mid-size carriers become a later segment, approached through partners. The sections below follow that order.

Reconciliation note (updated 2026-10-17): the investor-package TAM, SAM and SOM are in 05-market-size.md section 4 and use the finance model's revenue per account. The account counts for shippers (19,932, new in this version), importers, carriers and brokers come from this file. The importer, carrier and broker ceilings below still use our own bottom-up fees (20% contingency, $12,000 broker fee) and are a cross-check, not package numbers; the shipper ceiling uses the finance model's revenue per account.

We size four segments: mid-market shippers, SME ocean importers, small and mid-size carriers, and freight brokers. The shipper count is a model built from Census revenue classes and an old freight-to-sales ratio; the importer and carrier counts come straight from Census and FMCSA data.

Shared inputs

Three figures appear in more than one segment, so we state them once.

ATRI's detention study (released 10 September 2024, covering 2023) found drivers detained at 39.3% of stops, 94.5% of fleets charging detention, payment on "fewer than 50 percent of those invoices", $3.6B of direct expense and $11.5B of lost productivity. The repo's $15.1B figure checks out against the live source as the sum of those two parts ($3.6B + $11.5B = $15.1B). The repo's date "Sept 2024" is correct; the precise release date is 10 September 2024. Source: American Transportation Research Institute, "New Research Documents Substantial Financial and Safety Impacts from Truck Driver Detention", https://truckingresearch.org/2024/09/new-research-documents-substantial-financial-and-safety-impacts-from-truck-driver-detention/, accessed 2026-10-17

US business logistics costs were $2.40 trillion in 2025, with trucking at 36.8% of total logistics spend, according to the 2026 CSCMP State of Logistics report. That puts trucking at $883.2B (our arithmetic: $2.40T x 0.368). The figure includes private fleets and excludes parcel. The previous edition reported $2.58T for 2024, and the 2026 edition restates 2024 at $2.43T; we use the latest edition. Source: SCDigest, "First Thoughts" on the 2026 State of Logistics report (CSCMP, Kearney, Penske Logistics), https://www.scdigest.com/firstthoughts/26-06-26.php?cid=23144, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: SCDigest, coverage of the 2025 State of Logistics report, https://www.scdigest.com/firstthoughts/25-06-13_State_of_Logistics_2025.php?cid=22831, accessed 2026-10-17

The contingency fee used throughout is 20% of dollars recovered. This is ASSUMED. The business plan picks it from a vendor-stated 15% to 30% range (grade C), and no competitor we profiled publishes a contingency rate (see 01-competitors.md).

Mid-market shippers ($5M to $50M annual freight spend) — core segment

- What the industry does, in 3 sentences: These are manufacturers, wholesalers and retailers that buy truckload, LTL and ocean capacity from carriers, brokers and forwarders, but are too small for the enterprise freight audit programs of the incumbents. Their accounts-payable team receives carrier

invoices that carry accessorials (detention, lumper, liftgate, reweigh, redelivery, fuel surcharge) on top of the agreed rate. They need to separate owed charges from unsupported ones and short-pay or dispute with proof.

- Industry size (figure, source, date): $189.9B of estimated annual freight spend across the firms in the band (our arithmetic, below), against $883.2B of total US trucking spend in 2025 (CSCMP; see shared inputs). The firms in the band had $4,057.4B of receipts in 2022: manufacturing $1,268.9B, wholesale $1,848.3B, retail $940.2B (Census SUSB 2022, enterprise receipts classes $100M to $999.9M). Freight spend = $4,057.4B x 4.68% = $189.9B, about 21% of US trucking spend. The 4.68% ratio is ASSUMED to apply; see the next bullet for its source. Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Statistics of U.S. Businesses 2022, "Number of Firms and Establishments, Employment, Annual Payroll, and Receipts by Industry and Enterprise Receipts Size", release 10 April 2025, https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/susb/tables/2022/us_naicssector_large_rcptsize_2022.xlsx, accessed 2026-10-17 (copy in research/data/, extraction in research/scripts/susb_shipper_counts.py)
- Number of addressable companies (figure, source, date): 19,932 firms (manufacturing 5,971, wholesale 8,798, retail 5,163). No public dataset counts shippers by freight spend, so we convert the freight-spend band into a revenue band and count firms by revenue. Step 1, freight spend as a share of sales: Establish Inc.'s logistics cost survey, presented at CSCMP, put transportation at 4.68% of sales for the average participating company (manufacturers, distributors and retailers): "transportation is 4.68 percent of sales, warehousing is 1.9 percent, and inventory is 1.8 percent" (DC Velocity, 2008). This is the newest version of that ratio we could read at the source; a 2014 figure of 4.43% appears only in a slide deck we could not open. Grade: SOURCED-B, but 18 years old, and we ASSUME it still holds. Step 2, revenue band: $5M / 4.68% = $106.8M and $50M / 4.68% = $1.068B, which we round to the Census receipts classes $100M to $999.9M. Step 3, firm count: Census SUSB 2022 firms in those classes, NAICS 31-33, 42 and 44-45 = 19,932. Sensitivity: at 2% freight-to-sales the band becomes $250M to $2.5B and the count 9,366; at 10% it becomes $50M to $500M and the count 35,349 (the 10% case uses the $50M to $99.9M classes from the 6-digit SUSB receipts file, https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/susb/tables/2022/us_6digitnaics_rcptsize_2022.xlsx). Establish also reports that logistics costs run higher as a share of sales for smaller companies, which argues for the higher counts; retailers' lower transport share (a food-retail benchmark of 1.5% from 2001, too old to rely on) argues for fewer retail firms. Source: DC Velocity, "Logistics costs and services 2008" (Establish Inc. study presented at CSCMP), https://www.dcvelocity.com/articles/31001-logistics-costs-and-services-2008, accessed 2026-10-17 Tried and rejected: the BEA 2023 summary use table. In its purchasers'-price framework, freight on purchased goods sits inside the goods rows, so truck transportation shows as 0.03% of manufacturing output, which measures the accounting convention, not shippers' freight bills. Files kept outside the repo; noted in open-questions.md. Source: U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis, Supply-Use Tables 1997-2023 (AllTablesSUP.zip), https://apps.bea.gov/industry/iTables%20Static%20Files/AllTablesSUP.zip, accessed 2026-10-17
- Our realistic revenue ceiling here (show the arithmetic): average freight spend per firm = $189.9B / 19,932 = $9.53M. At 1% recoverable unsupported accessorials and errors (ASSUMED; audit vendors claim 1% to 9%, grade C) a typical account recovers $95.3K a year, which sits inside the finance model's recovery path of $85K (year 3) to $115K (year 7). Using the finance model's year-7 revenue per shipper account of $27.6K: 19,932 x $27.6K = $550.1M a year at 100% penetration. The finance base case has 304 shipper accounts in year 7 (financial/scenarios.md), 1.5% of these firms; the model prices a shipper at $27.6K in year 7, below the importer's $30.8K, because a shipper has no ocean D&D to recover. Source: finance worktree, financial/assumptions.md (inputs recov, share, fee) and financial/scenarios.md, dated 2026-10-17
- Competitors active in this industry specifically: Loop (now carries Data2Logistics, which served small, mid-size and enterprise customers), Intelligent Audit (Catalyst for SMBs, parcel only so far), CTSI-Global and nVision Global (services-led), Cass (enterprise-weighted). Mid-market fit for each is in 01-competitors.md.

- Why this industry buys software like ours: RXO's November 2024 survey of 750 shippers and carriers found that "61% of shippers agree that managing accessorial requests is one of the biggest time-wasters for their accounting team" and that 84% of shippers see a moderate (65%) or significant (19%) budget impact from accessorials; the same survey found 70% of shippers think carriers are usually honest, so the pain is workload more than fraud (details and source in 04-gaps.md, Gap 5). Vendors also describe accessorial verification as manual: Banyan Technology, a TMS vendor, frames the goal as turning "accessorial verification from a manual, reactive task into a proactive and automated process" (April 2025). That one is a vendor framing, not buyer testimony. Source: Banyan Technology blog, "Why accessorial verification is critical to controlling freight spend", 22 April 2025, https://blog.banyantechnology.com/why-accessorial-verification-is-critical-to-controlling-freight-spend, accessed 2026-10-17

Ocean importers paying container demurrage and detention — core segment

- What the industry does, in 3 sentences: These are US companies that import goods in ocean containers, mostly manufacturers and wholesalers buying from overseas suppliers. When a container sits at the terminal past its free days (demurrage) or the empty box is returned late (detention), the ocean carrier or terminal invoices a per-day fee. Since May 2024 the FMC billing rule fixes what a valid invoice must contain and sets 30-day windows to issue, dispute and answer it.
- Industry size (figure, source, date): the FMC reports that the nine largest ocean carriers "have collected roughly $15.4 billion in D&D charges between April 1, 2020, and March 31, 2025". Over those five years that averages $3.08B a year (our arithmetic: $15.4B / 5). The FMC page does not say whether the figure covers US trades only; we assume it does because the FMC collects it under its US jurisdiction, and we list that as an open question. Source: Federal Maritime Commission, Detention and Demurrage, https://www.fmc.gov/detention-and-demurrage/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Number of addressable companies (figure, source, date): 240,535 identified US importing companies in 2024, of which 234,023 are small and medium enterprises (under 500 employees) and 6,512 are large. SME importers accounted for $884B of the $2,926B known import value (30.2%, our arithmetic). Manufacturers made up 17.4% of importers and wholesalers 36.5%. The Census count is all modes; the number that import by ocean container is UNKNOWN — needs primary research. Source: U.S. Census Bureau, "A Profile of U.S. Importing and Exporting Companies, 2023-2024", release CB26-73, 5 May 2026, https://www.census.gov/foreign-trade/Press-Release/edb/edbrel2024.pdf, accessed 2026-10-17
- Importers by size, for the finance model (added 2026-10-17): the business case's importer moves about 2,000 TEU a year, and finance asked how many US importers bring in 500 to 5,000 TEU. No public source counts importers by container volume or by import value; Census publishes counts by employment size only. What can be built from public data: Value per TEU: US containerized vessel imports were worth $975.3B in 2023 (BTS, sum of East $480.9B, Gulf $105.0B, West $387.4B and Great Lakes $2.0B). At 28.9 million TEU imported in 2023 (S&P Global Market Intelligence, via a search summary we could not open at the source) that is $33.7K per TEU (our arithmetic). So 500 to 5,000 TEU is about $16.9M to $168.7M of containerized imports a year, and 2,000 TEU is about $67.5M. A different tracker (Descartes) reports 28.2 million TEU for 2024, so the per-TEU value is approximate. Importers by employment size, 2024 (Census Table 1d), with average import value per importer (our arithmetic): 100 to 249 employees, 9,607 importers, average $14.8M; 250 to 499 employees, 4,160 importers, average $33.1M; 500 or more employees, 6,512 importers, average $313.6M. Averages are of all import modes, not only containers. Bound: the 500 to 5,000 TEU band sits above the average SME importer and below the average large importer. A loose range is 4,160 (only the 250 to 499 class) to 20,279 (all importers with 100 or more employees). The FMC-pool cap used in 05-market-size.md, 12,833 importers at the business case's $240K D&D exposure, falls inside that range, which is why we keep it as the SAM importer count. It also means the business-case importer is closer to a "large" importer by Census's employment definition than to a typical SME. An exact count needs bill-of-lading data (for example PIERS or ImportGenius) and is listed in open-questions.md. Source: Bureau of

Transportation Statistics, "Value of Containerized Imports by Coast in 2023" (dataset ub6a-sqr5), https://data.transportation.gov/resource/ub6a-sqr5.json, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: U.S. Census Bureau, "A Profile of U.S. Importing and Exporting Companies, 2023-2024", Table 1d (edbrelxlsx2024.zip), https://www.census.gov/foreign-trade/Press-Release/edb/edbrelxlsx2024.zip, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: search summary of S&P Global Market Intelligence data, "For all of calendar year 2023, imports fell 8.5%, to 28.9 million TEU", reported via Logistics Management, https://www.logisticsmgmt.com/topic/tag/Twenty-Foot_Equivalent_Units/P45, accessed 2026-10-17 (primary not opened)

- Our realistic revenue ceiling here (show the arithmetic): $3.08B a year collected (SOURCED, FMC) x 10% recoverable through a well-founded dispute (ASSUMED; a 30% to 40% "inaccurate invoice" estimate circulates in FMC docket commentary, but we could not open the primary comment, so we do not use it) x 20% fee (ASSUMED) = $61.6M a year at 100% share of the whole market. Restricting to SME importers by their share of import value: $61.6M x 30.2% = $18.6M a year at 100% share of SMEs. Realistic ceiling: 5% of the SME slice by year 5 (ASSUMED) = $0.93M a year. On these inputs ocean D&D is a feature that deepens an importer account, not a standalone business. BlueCargo's claim of "$350M+ in Detention & Demurrage Savings" (vendor claim, grade C) hints that our 10% recoverable input may be low, which makes it the input to test first.
- Competitors active in this industry specifically: BlueCargo, Portcast (adjacent), Intelligent Audit (D&D invoice validation case study), nVision Global (D&D audit content).
- Why this industry buys software like ours: the FMC rule makes compliance checkable by rule. In Thompson Hine's words, "Failure of the billing party to abide by the invoice content and timing requirements relieves the billed party's obligation to pay an invoice for detention and demurrage charges", and the billed party has 30 calendar days from issuance to request mitigation, refund or waiver. A September 2025 D.C. Circuit decision vacated only the section on who may be billed (46 C.F.R. 541.4); the content and dispute provisions remain in force. Deadline tracking and field-by-field invoice checks are what our D&D module and claims state machine already do on synthetic data. Source: Thompson Hine, "FMC Issues Final Rule on Billing Requirements and Practices for Detention and Demurrage Invoices", https://www.thompsonhine.com/insights/fmc-issues-final-rule-on-billing-requirements-and-practices-for-detention-and-demurrage-invoices/, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Thompson Hine, "Court Sets Aside Part of FMC's Demurrage and Detention Billing Rule", 26 September 2025, https://www.thompsonhine.com/insights/court-sets-aside-part-of-fmcs-demurrage-and-detention-billing-rule/, accessed 2026-10-17

Small and mid-size for-hire truckload carriers (5 to 100 power units) — later segment, partner channel

- What the industry does, in 3 sentences: These are trucking companies that haul freight for shippers and brokers under their own operating authority, usually with 5 to 100 tractors. They bill a linehaul rate plus accessorials such as detention, layover, lumper reimbursement and truck-ordered-not-used, and they wait on payment from brokers or shippers. Most run a small back office, often the owner plus a dispatcher and a biller, with telematics from an ELD vendor.
- Industry size (figure, source, date): US trucking spend of $883.2B in 2025 (CSCMP, see shared inputs; includes private fleets, so it overstates the for-hire market). ATRI puts unreimbursed direct detention expense for the industry at $3.6B in 2023. Source: as in shared inputs, accessed 2026-10-17
- Number of addressable companies (figure, source, date): 72,053 active interstate for-hire carriers with 5 to 100 power units that filed an MCS-150 update since 17 October 2024; together they report 1,206,250 power units (average 16.7). Without the recency filter the count is 80,296. Of the 72,053, 57,712 list general freight as a cargo type. The full active interstate for-hire population is 532,506, of which 403,115 have 1 to 4 power units and 3,752 have more than 100. We queried the FMCSA file directly on 2026-10-17; the latest MCS-150 date in the file was 15 October 2026. The query is saved in research/scripts/fmcsa_carrier_counts.sh. Source: FMCSA, Company Census File (dataset az4n-8mr2), https://data.transportation.gov/resource/az4n-8mr2.json, accessed 2026-10-17 Cross-check:

ATA's American Trucking Trends 2025, as reported by FleetOwner, says 91.5% of carriers operate 10 or fewer trucks; FleetOwner also cites FMCSA at about 1.1 million for-hire carriers, a count that includes intrastate and inactive-looking registrations. Source: FleetOwner, "Trucking By the Numbers 2025 Overview", https://fleetowner.com/research/truck-by-numbers/media-gallery/55338098/trucking-by-the-numbers-2025-overview-carrier-composition-costs-and-impact, accessed 2026-10-17

- Our realistic revenue ceiling here (show the arithmetic): Inputs per power unit per year: 400 stops (ASSUMED: about 2 stops a working day over 200 days) x 39.3% detained (SOURCED, ATRI) x $100 billable detention per detained stop (ASSUMED; ATRI's 2019 survey found an average detention fee of $63.71 an hour, so $100 is about 1.6 billable hours) x 50% unpaid (SOURCED as a conservative floor: ATRI says fewer than 50 percent of detention invoices are paid, so the unpaid share is above 50%; billed-but-unpaid and never-billed are not separated in the release) x 30% winnable with an evidence packet (ASSUMED) = $2,358 recoverable per power unit per year. Fee: $2,358 × 20% (ASSUMED) = $471.60 per power unit per year, or $7,895 per average carrier (16.74 power units). Whole segment at 100% penetration: 1,206,250 power units x $471.60 = $568.9M a year. This is a theoretical maximum, not a target. Realistic ceiling: 3% of the 72,053 carriers by year 5 (ASSUMED) = 2,162 carriers x $7,895 = $17.1M a year in fees. Source for the $63.71 figure: J. J. Keller Compliance Network, "ATRI: Driver detention frequency, length on the rise", 5 September 2019, https://jjkellercompliancenetwork.com/news/atri-driver-detention-frequency-length-on-the-rise, accessed 2026-10-17
- Competitors active in this industry specifically: Hey Bubba (geofence detention claims inside an AI dispatcher), FleetOptos (Geotab-based detention billing), Detention Source (iOS app). None of the six FAP firms in 01-competitors.md sells to carriers.
- Why this industry buys software like ours: the money is plainly owed to them and they lose it for want of proof. In DAT's 2016 survey of 257 carriers, 84% named detention a top-five business problem and "Only three percent of carriers were paid on 90 percent or more of their detention claims". In a 2025 TruckersReport forum poll, the most-chosen reason for denied claims (7 of 13 votes, 53.8%) was "They just ignore my request / It's too much hassle to fight for it". The business plan assumes carriers have small software budgets, which is why it prices this segment on contingency; that assumption is untested. Source: DAT Solutions, "63 Percent of Drivers are Detained for More Than 3 Hours Per Stop", 14 July 2016, https://www.dat.com/company/news-events/news-releases/63-percent-of-drivers-are-detained-for-more-than-3-hours-per-stop-dat-solutions, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: TheTruckersReport forum, "What's the #1 reason your detention claims get denied? (poll)", https://www.thetruckersreport.com/truckingindustryforum/threads/whats-the-1-reason-your-detention-claims-get-denied-poll.2529156/page-3, accessed 2026-10-17

Freight brokers and 3PLs

- What the industry does, in 3 sentences: Brokers arrange truckload capacity for shippers, paying carriers and billing shippers for the same load. On detention they sit in the middle, approving or rejecting the carrier’s claim and trying to rebill the shipper. Many run thin margins and an operations team that handles accessorial approvals by email.
- Industry size (figure, source, date): UNKNOWN — needs primary research (we did not reach a primary source for brokerage gross revenue this session).
- Number of addressable companies (figure, source, date): 28,438 active freight brokerage authorities in January 2024, down 7.8% year on year (Carrier Details and Brush Pass Research). This is the newest figure we found; the FMCSA census dataset we queried for carriers returned only 3 active rows classed as brokers, so it is not the right file for broker counts. Source: FreightCaviar, "Brush Pass Research: 7.8% fewer brokerages than a year ago", 24 January 2024, https://freightcaviar.com/brush-pass-research-7-8-fewer-brokerages-than-a-year-ago, accessed 2026-10-17
- Our realistic revenue ceiling here (show the arithmetic): brokers are a software sale, not a contingency sale, because the recovered money flows through them. At $12,000 a year per broker (ASSUMED, from the plan’s phase-2 platform fee of $1,000 a month), 28,438 brokers x $12,000 = $341.3M at 100%

penetration. Realistic ceiling at 1% by year 5 (ASSUMED) = 284 brokers and $3.4M a year.
- Competitors active in this industry specifically: Loop (sells to brokers, per Sacra) and BlueCargo (drayage brokers). TMS vendors are the default substitute; we did not research them this session.
- Why this industry buys software like ours: DAT found that "Two-thirds of brokers surveyed said they paid detention only when they could collect the fee from the shipper or consignee". A broker who can rebill the shipper with a cited packet keeps the carrier relationship without absorbing the cost. The same survey found only 20% of 50 responding brokers ranked detention a top-five problem, against 84% of carriers, which warns that brokers may feel the pain less than the carriers they pay. Source: DAT Solutions, 14 July 2016, https://www.dat.com/company/news-events/news-releases/63-percent-of-drivers-are-detained-for-more-than-3-hours-per-stop-dat-solutions, accessed 2026-10-17

Reading the four together

The two core segments now have counts: 19,932 mid-market shippers (a modelled count, sensitive to the freight-to-sales ratio: 9,366 at 2%, 35,349 at 10%) and 234,023 SME importers, of which the FMC D&D pool can support only about 12,833 at the business case's exposure (05-market-size.md section 5). The shipper count rests on a ratio from 2008, so it is the input to refresh first, ideally with a purchased firmographic list filtered by revenue and industry. Shippers carry the largest dollars per account: an average of $9.53M of freight spend, so about $95K recovered at an assumed 1%, which sits inside the finance model's recovery path.

Carriers keep the best demand evidence and the best data, but the smallest dollars per account, and the owner has moved them to a later, partner-led segment. Brokers sit between carrier and shipper and stay outside the SAM until a pilot shows they buy.

The first job of a design-partner pilot is to replace the ASSUMED inputs that drive these figures: the recoverable share of shipper spend, the recoverable share of D&D charges, the fee path, and the freight-to-sales ratio behind the shipper count.

03 Feature matrix

Status: pre-product. The scoup.ai row describes code that exists in the build worktree and runs on synthetic data only; it has never been deployed or used by a customer. "partial" in the scoup.ai row means "built and tested on synthetic data, not proven in use".

Research date: 2026-10-17.

Cell rules

- `yes`: the company documents the capability on its own site or in a cited source (see 01-competitors.md for URLs).
- `partial`: documented, but limited in a way stated in the notes (one mode, one telematics vendor, enterprise only, roadmap language).
- `no`: we checked and the capability is absent. We use `no` only where we looked for something specific and could see it missing: a pricing page with no price, a product whose stated scope excludes it, or scoup.ai code without it.
- `unknown`: not documented in anything we read. Absence of marketing is not evidence of absence, so most undocumented cells are `unknown`, not `no`.

Columns

Code	Capability
C1	Sells to carriers (claims for money owed to the carrier)
C2	Captures detention time from ELD or geofence data
C3	Builds a claim packet where each figure cites its source document
C4	Extracts detention or accessorial terms from rate confirmations or contracts
C5	Audits shipper-side freight invoices against rates
C6	Validates accessorial charges specifically
C7	Tracks disputes to resolution (status, deadlines)
C8	Audits ocean demurrage and detention invoices
C9	Checks D&D invoices against the FMC billing rule (OSRA)
C10	Pays carriers (freight payment)
C11	Requires a second person to approve outgoing claims (four-eyes)
C12	Fuel-surcharge outlook or forecast
C13	Publishes prices

Matrix

Company	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	C6	C7	C8	C9	C10	C11	C12	C13
Loop	unknown	unknown	unknown	partial	yes	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	yes	unknown	unknown	no
Cass Information Systems	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	yes	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	yes	unknown	unknown	no
Trax Technologies	unknown	unknown	unknown	partial	yes	yes	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	no
CTSI-Global	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	yes	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	yes	unknown	unknown	no

Company	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	C6	C7	C8	C9	C10	C11	C12	C13
nVision Global	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	yes	unknown	partial	partial	unknown	yes	unknown	unknown	no
Intelligent Audit	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	yes	yes	unknown	partial	unknown	unknown	unknown	unknown	no
BlueCargo	partial	unknown	partial	unknown	yes	unknown	yes	yes	yes	yes	unknown	unknown	no
Hey Bubba	yes	yes	partial	partial	no	unknown	unknown	no	no	unknown	unknown	unknown	no
FleetOptos	yes	partial	unknown	partial	no	unknown	unknown	no	no	unknown	unknown	unknown	no
scoup.ai (pre-product)	partial	no	partial	partial	partial	partial	partial	partial	partial	no	partial	partial	no

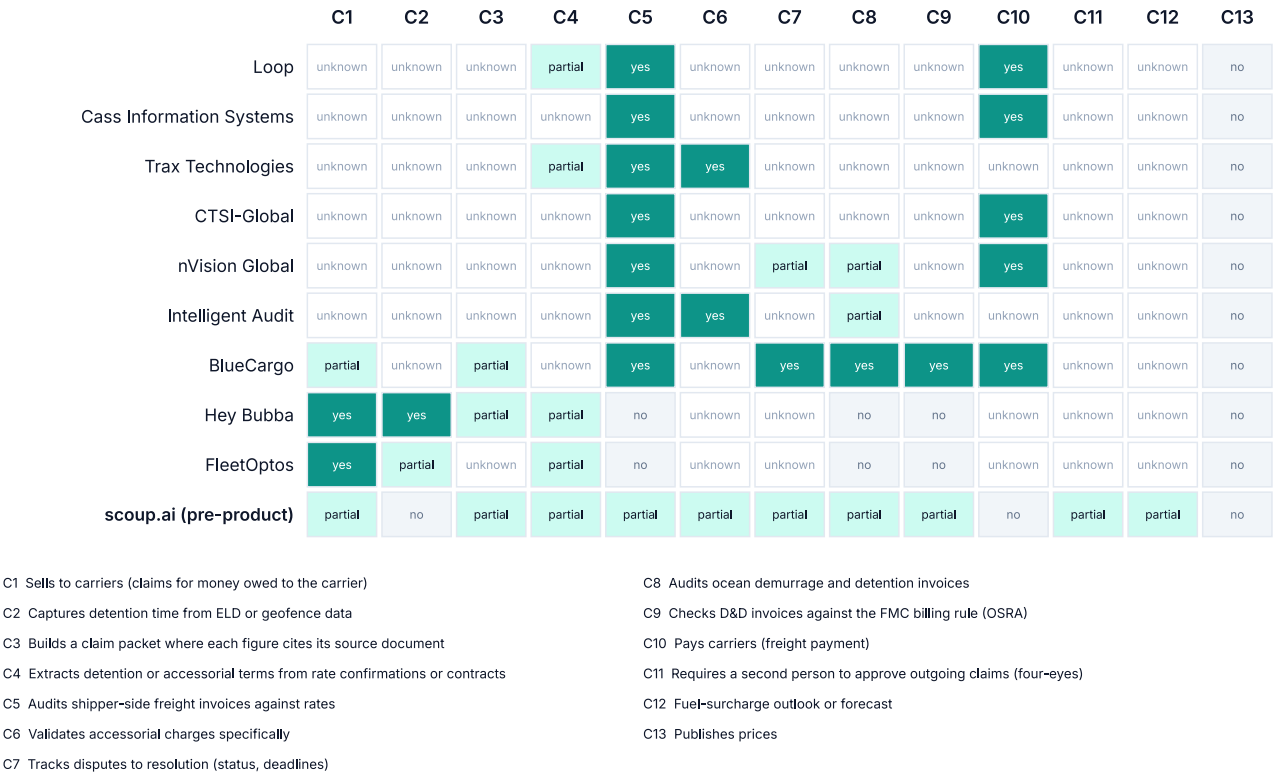


Figure 1: Competitor feature matrix (yes, partial, no or unknown per capability C1 to C13); the scoup.ai row is pre-product code tested on synthetic data only. Source: research/03-feature-matrix.md § Matrix and § Columns

Evidence for every cell that is not `unknown`

Sources and URLs for each company are in 01-competitors.md; all were accessed 2026-10-17.

Loop. C4 partial: the home page lists "parcel contract intelligence", which covers parcel contracts, not truckload rate confirmations. C5 yes: "freight audit". C10 yes: "carrier payments". C13 no: https://loop.com/pricing returned HTTP 404 and the site shows no prices.

Cass. C5 yes: "Freight Audit". C10 yes: "Freight Payment". C13 no: the freight audit page shows no prices.

Trax. C4 partial: "Invoice-Contract Intelligence" appears on the AI roadmap page as a direction, not a shipped feature. C5 yes: global freight audit. C6 yes: its blog says the audit flags "missing or incorrect accessorial fees". C13 no: no prices published.

CTSI-Global. C5 yes and C10 yes: "Freight Audit + Payment" on the home page. C13 no: no prices published.

nVision Global. C5 yes and C10 yes: "Freight Audit and Payment". C7 partial: "Freight Claims" is a documented service, but it concerns cargo loss and damage, not detention or accessorial disputes. C8 partial: a company blog post explains D&D invoice auditing; we found no product page for it. C13 no: no prices published.

Intelligent Audit. C5 yes: multimodal audit per its FAQ. C6 yes: the FAQ says it "reviews accessorial charges". C8 partial: a published case study on D&D invoice validation, not a stated product line. C13 no: the FAQ describes a subscription without publishing prices, and Catalyst plan prices are not shown.

BlueCargo. C1 partial: lists "Drayage Carriers & Brokers" among customers, but only for port and drayage charges. C3 partial: markets "Dispute resolution with evidence-backed documentation"; we could not see whether each figure is tied to a source. C5 yes and C10 yes: "Freight Audit & Pay (pre-audit and post-audit)". C7 yes: dispute resolution with a claimed "95% Dispute Success" (vendor claim). C8 yes: D&D is its core. C9 yes: invoice validation "against OSRA invoice requirements". C13 no: no prices published.

Hey Bubba. C1 yes and C2 yes: logs detention claims from ELD geofence crossings for owner-operators and fleets. C3 partial: "logs the detention claim with timestamps attached", which attaches evidence but does not describe per-figure citations. C4 partial: "detention terms recorded at booking"; the page does not say whether terms are read from documents or typed in. C5, C8, C9 no: its stated customers are carriers, and shipper invoice audit and ocean D&D are outside that scope. C13 no: https://bubba.ai/pricing returned HTTP 404.

FleetOptos. C1 yes: detention billing for trucking fleets. C2 partial: Geotab telematics only. C4 partial: "applies contract-specific billing rules (free time allowances, hourly rates)"; extraction from documents is not described. C5, C8, C9 no: the listing scopes it to fleets running Geotab. C13 no: the marketplace listing shows no price.

The scoup.ai row (pre-product, synthetic data only). Evidence is code in the build worktree (C:\Users\mariu\ventures\freight-recovery-build, branch feat/hardening), not customer use. - C1 partial: claims module (api/src/claims) builds detention and accessorial packets. - C2 no: we found no ELD or geofence integration in api/src; timestamps come from uploaded documents. - C3 partial: findings carry hash citations to source fields (api/src/claims/analysis.ts). - C4 partial: the import pipeline extracts fields from documents (api/src/imports/parse); extraction accuracy on real rate confirmations is unmeasured. - C5 partial: the fuel check compares charged surcharge with the carrier's schedule and diesel data (api/src/intelligence/fuel.ts); there is no general rate-contract audit. - C6 partial: charge intelligence classifies invoice lines into charge categories with tenant labels (api/src/intelligence/charges.ts). - C7 partial: claim state machine (api/src/claims/state-machine.ts) tracks status; deadline tracking is shown for ocean D&D below. - C8 partial and C9 partial: ocean D&D audit runs (api/src/ocean-dd/audit-run.ts), including the 30-day issuance limit under 46 CFR 541.7. - C10 no: the product does not move money. - C11 partial: four-eyes rules refuse approve or reject transitions to any author of the claim (api/src/claims/service.ts, REQ-20261009-four-eyes). - C12 partial: fuel-surcharge tables and outlook routes exist (api/src/intelligence/fuel.ts, outlook-routes.ts). - C13 no: no published pricing; pre-product.

Reading the matrix

The column that separates the groups is C1. The six FAP firms document shipper-side audit and payment and say nothing about carrier claims, while the two carrier tools document geofence capture and nothing on the shipper side. C3 and C4, the cited packet and term extraction, have no `yes` from any competitor; that is

consistent with Gaps 1 and 2 in 04-gaps.md, with the caveat that most cells are `unknown` rather than confirmed absences. C9 has exactly one `yes` (BlueCargo), which is why we call Gap 3 partial. The scoup.ai row has more `partial` cells than any competitor has `yes` cells, and that should be read as breadth of prototype, not proof of capability: nothing in the scoup.ai row has met a real document or a real counterparty.

04 Gaps

Status: pre-product. The product, scoup.ai, uses synthetic data only, never deployed, no paying customers. A gap below means "no competitor we profiled covers this well, and people outside our company have said they need it". It does not mean we have shown scoup.ai closes the gap; nothing here has been measured on real claims.

Research date: 2026-10-17. Competitor coverage refers to the nine companies in 01-competitors.md and the cells in 03-feature-matrix.md. Quotes were checked against the raw page text, not only a summary, unless marked otherwise.

How we judged a gap

A capability counts as a gap when two things hold. First, no profiled competitor documents it publicly, or only one does and only for a segment we do not target. Second, we can quote demand for it from a source that is not a vendor selling the fix: a regulator, a trade survey, a court or legal analysis, or practitioners on a public forum. Vendor blogs count only as weak support and are labelled so. Where we found a plausible gap but no outside demand evidence, it goes in the last section rather than being promoted.

Gap 1: A cited evidence packet for the carrier who is owed detention

The carrier-side tools we found (Hey Bubba, FleetOptos, Detention Source) record geofence arrival and departure and create a claim line. The FAP firms do not sell to carriers at all. Nobody we profiled documents the next step: pulling the free-time clause from the rate confirmation, the BOL or POD times, the appointment record, the geofence log and any lumper receipt into one packet where every number points at its source. That packet is the core of scoup.ai's claims module.

The demand evidence is about proof, not about tracking. Carriers say claims die because they cannot show the time in a form the payer accepts.

- ATRI: "94.5 percent of fleets charge detention fees", yet they are paid for "fewer than 50 percent of those invoices" (release of 10 September 2024). Source: American Transportation Research Institute, https://truckingresearch.org/2024/09/new-research-documents-substantial-financial-and-safety-impacts-from-truck-driver-detention/, accessed 2026-10-17
- DAT survey of 257 carriers: "Only three percent of carriers were paid on 90 percent or more of their detention claims, at a rate between $30 and $50 per hour" (14 July 2016; old, but the only survey we found that measures paid share per carrier). Source: DAT Solutions, https://www.dat.com/company/news-events/news-releases/63-percent-of-drivers-are-detained-for-more-than-3-hours-per-stop-dat-solutions, accessed 2026-10-17
- A driver on TheTruckersReport, describing how they protect claims (August 2025): "I always note my arrival and departure times on my freight bill as well as a note for the reason (ie, "line of trucks", "out of product", "mill down for repairs"...". The same thread's poll had 7 of 13 votes (53.8%) for "They just ignore my request / It's too much hassle to fight for it". The sample is tiny; we quote it for the wording, not the percentage. Source: TheTruckersReport forum, https://www.thetruckersreport.com/truckingindustryforum/threads/whats-the-1-reason-your-detention-claims-get-denied-poll.2529156/page-3, accessed 2026-10-17
- The same thread shows what happens when the evidence is automatic: "Where I'm at as a company driver we're geo-fenced at all locations so the wait time is automatically accounted for and paid. Drivers don't have to do anything it pays like clockwork." That is a large fleet with its own systems; the 5 to 100 truck carrier usually has the geofence data in an ELD and no one to turn it into a claim. Source: same thread, accessed 2026-10-17

Why it stays open: tracking vendors stop at the timestamp because the packet needs document extraction and contract reading, which is a different product. Audit firms stop at the invoice because the carrier is not their customer.

Gap 2: Machine-readable detention terms when every broker writes its own

Detention terms are not standard. Free time, hourly rate, cap, notice requirements and disqualifying conditions vary by broker and shipper, and they live in rate confirmations and broker policies. FleetOptos says it applies "contract-specific billing rules (free time allowances, hourly rates)", which suggests the rules are configured by hand. No profiled competitor documents extracting those terms from the document into rules that a calculation can cite. Source: Geotab Marketplace, FleetOptos listing, https://marketplace.geotab.com/solutions/fleetoptos/, accessed 2026-10-17

- A carrier posting in January 2025: "Detention pay on a industry standard was 2 hrs, 3hrs, and sometimes 4 hrs. A broker told hs that their us no standard." In the next post the same user quotes a broker's written refusal: "Per our company policy in line with industry standards. We cannot and will not compensate for any layovers or detention if the driver left the shipper before getting loaded." Source: TheTruckersReport forum, "Broker doesn't want to pay / one of those days", page 2, https://www.thetruckersreport.com/truckingindustryforum/threads/broker-doesn%E2%80%99t-want-to-pay-one-of-those-days.2519612/page-2, accessed 2026-10-17
- Another member (August 2025): "They all have different policy and procedures there though so it's not uniform and can be a headache." Source: TheTruckersReport forum, poll thread above, accessed 2026-10-17

Why it stays open: rule bases at the audit firms are built for contract freight rates at large shippers, and the carrier tools have no document intake. The rules engine in scoup.ai already separates extracted terms from the calculation; whether extraction holds up on real rate confirmations is unmeasured.

Gap 3: FMC-rule checks and dispute deadlines for small and mid-size importers

This one is a partial gap, and we say so. BlueCargo markets invoice checks "against OSRA invoice requirements" and "Dispute resolution with evidence-backed documentation", and claims "1 in 5 Top US Shippers" as customers. That covers the large importer at the big ports. We found no competitor that packages the same checks for the 234,023 SME importers in the Census profile, or ties the 30-day dispute clock into a claims workflow that also handles truck detention for the same shipments. Source: BlueCargo, home page, https://www.bluecargo.io/home-tests, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: U.S. Census Bureau, release CB26-73, https://www.census.gov/foreign-trade/Press-Release/edb/edbrel2024.pdf, accessed 2026-10-17

The rule itself creates the demand, because a missed deadline or a missing field changes who pays.

- Thompson Hine on the FMC final rule: "Failure of the billing party to abide by the invoice content and timing requirements relieves the billed party's obligation to pay an invoice for detention and demurrage charges." And: "The party that receives the invoice has 30 calendar days from the date of issuance to request mitigation, refund, or waiver". Source: Thompson Hine, https://www.thompsonhine.com/insights/fmc-issues-final-rule-on-billing-requirements-and-practices-for-detention-and-demurrage-invoices/, accessed 2026-10-17
- After the D.C. Circuit's September 2025 ruling: "Apart from the vacatur of 46 C.F.R. § 541.4, the FMC's Final Rule on demurrage and detention remains in effect." Source: Thompson Hine, 26 September 2025, https://www.thompsonhine.com/insights/court-sets-aside-part-of-fmcs-demurrage-and-detention-billing-rule/, accessed 2026-10-17

- Volume of disputes: "HTA members disputed more than 3 million detention and demurrage charges in 2020, according to the organization. The majority of survey participants (65%) said the most common reason for disputes was "no available appointments."" (Harbor Trucking Association, reported by Supply Chain Dive.) Source: Supply Chain Dive, Harbor Trucking Association survey coverage, https://www.supplychaindive.com/news/detention-demurrage-port-congestion-fees-Harbor-Trucking-Association-TradeLanes/594406/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Money at stake: the nine largest carriers "have collected roughly $15.4 billion in D&D charges between April 1, 2020, and March 31, 2025." Source: Federal Maritime Commission, https://www.fmc.gov/detention-and-demurrage/, accessed 2026-10-17

Why it stays open for SMEs: the specialist serves the top of the market, and the FAP firms treat D&D as one more audit line. At our assumed recovery rate (02-industries.md) this is a feature that wins importer accounts, not a business on its own.

Gap 4: One packet the broker can use on both sides of the load

A broker that approves a carrier's detention claim usually wants to rebill the shipper with the same proof. No profiled competitor documents producing a packet meant to travel from carrier to broker to shipper. Loop sells to brokers, but its public pages describe audit and payment, not detention rebilling. Source: Loop, home page, https://www.loop.com/, accessed 2026-10-17

- DAT: "Two-thirds of brokers surveyed said they paid detention only when they could collect the fee from the shipper or consignee, while the other one-third of brokers paid detention whenever carriers complained." Brokers that were "reimbursed by their shipper customers were twice as likely to compensate carriers for detention." Source: DAT Solutions, 14 July 2016, https://www.dat.com/company/news-events/news-releases/63-percent-of-drivers-are-detained-for-more-than-3-hours-per-stop-dat-solutions, accessed 2026-10-17
- Counter-evidence we must keep in view: the same release says that among 50 brokers "only 20 percent agreed that detention was one of their top five problems". Demand on the broker side may be weaker than on the carrier side.

Why it stays open: each existing tool is built for one party. A two-sided packet only makes sense to a vendor that sells to both, and the incumbents sell to shippers.

Gap 5: Auditing accessorials and fuel surcharge against the shipper's own rate confirmation and FSC table (added 2026-10-17)

This is the capability the architect lists as lead innovation I1: check each carrier accessorial and fuel-surcharge line against the shipper's own rate confirmation and fuel-surcharge (FSC) schedule, and produce a short-pay packet. Coverage: Trax and Intelligent Audit say they audit accessorials (01-competitors.md), so this is not unserved at the enterprise end; the gap is the mid-market shipper, where no profiled competitor publishes a freight (non-parcel) offer.

What we searched on 2026-10-17: shipper surveys on freight invoice errors and accessorial overcharges (CSCMP, Gartner, ARC, APQC, Logistics Management, SupplyChainBrain), shipper associations (NASSTRAC), practitioner forums (Reddit, TheTruckersReport) and analyst reports. Results:

- Found, independent of audit vendors: RXO's survey of 750 shippers and carriers on truckload accessorials (published 25 November 2024). RXO is a freight broker, not an audit vendor, so it has no audit product to sell, but it is not neutral either. Verbatim findings for shippers:
- "61% of shippers agree that managing accessorial requests is one of the biggest time-wasters for their accounting team."

- "65% of shippers think accessorials they have a moderate impact to their freight budget and 19% thinking they have a significant impact."
- "71% are actively working on reducing accessorial spend with strategic initiatives, and a further 26% are planning to do so in the near future."
- "80% of shippers would rather pay higher freight rates up front than deal with accessorials on the back end."
- Counter-evidence, which matters for the pitch: "70% of shippers agree that carriers are usually honest when requesting accessorials — only 8% thought there was outright dishonesty", and "67% of shippers think they're paying the industry standard". Source: RXO, "What Shippers & Carriers Really Think About Trucking Accessorials (Original Research)", https://rxo.com/resources/research/freight-accessorials/, accessed 2026-10-17
- Found, old: Transplace's accessorial benchmarking study of more than 150 shippers with over $12 billion of annual freight spend, which found the fuel surcharge to be the most common accessorial that shippers publish (93% of companies, per search summaries of the article; SupplyChainBrain dates it 2014). It supports the premise that shippers hold their own FSC schedules to audit against. We could not read the article text (several mirrors returned HTTP 403 or no readable text). Source: SupplyChainBrain, "Fuel Surcharges Are Most Common Accessorial Published by Shippers: Benchmarking", https://supplychainbrain.com/articles/18205-fuel-surcharges-are-most-common-accessorial-published-by-shippers-benchmarking, accessed 2026-10-17
- Not found: any CSCMP, Gartner, ARC, APQC or NASSTRAC figure on the rate of accessorial or FSC overcharges at shippers. The error-rate figures that circulate (3% to 10% of invoices, 1% to 9% of spend) trace back to audit vendors or vendor-cited consultancies and stay grade C. A Flock Freight / Drive Research figure that "83.9% of LTL shippers" are charged accessorials often appears in search summaries, but the press release page returned no readable text, so we do not use it. We found no shipper-side practitioner thread on Reddit through search.

Reading: the independent evidence supports I1 as a workload problem (accessorial requests eat accounting time, and shippers want them simpler) more than an overcharge problem (most shippers think carriers are honest and rates are standard). The pitch for I1 should lead with "verify every accessorial and fuel line in minutes against your own terms" rather than "carriers are overbilling you". The size of recoverable overcharges for mid-market shippers stays an assumption (1% of spend) until design-partner data replaces it.

Candidate gaps without outside demand evidence

These are capabilities scoup.ai has that we did not find documented by any profiled competitor. We did not find independent sources asking for them, so they are not counted as gaps above. Each needs buyer interviews before anyone puts it in a pitch.

- Four-eyes approval before a claim or demand letter is sent. No competitor page we read describes a second-person approval gate on outgoing disputes. The business plan cites the risk that a carrier hesitates to dun a shipper it depends on; that is our own reasoning, not buyer testimony.
- Fuel-surcharge outlook. Fuel surcharge is widely described as the largest accessorial, but our only sources for its size are vendor blogs (grade C), and we found no buyer asking for a forecast.
- Charge intelligence and priority scoring (which open charges to dispute first). Plausible for a small back office with limited hours; no outside evidence gathered.
- Dispute-outcome data (which evidence wins against which counterparty). This is the moat the business plan describes. It does not exist until there is real claim volume, and no buyer can ask for a dataset they have never seen.

What this means for the pitch

The owner has since chosen a shipper- and importer-first strategy (2026-10-17). Read against it, Gap 3 (FMC-rule checks and dispute deadlines for SME importers) is the gap that sits inside the core market, though BlueCargo covers the enterprise end. The strongest gap with outside evidence is still Gap 1, which is carrier-side and therefore a later, partner-led segment; its evidence also explains why shippers receive detention claims they cannot verify. Gap 2 is the technical reason Gap 1 is hard and applies equally to a shipper checking a carrier’s claim against the rate confirmation. Gap 4 is a distribution idea with mixed evidence. We found no independent shipper survey on accessorial disputes, which is the main evidence hole for the core segment. None of these has been tested with a paying customer, and the honest pitch says the evidence shows a problem people describe, not a product people have bought.

05 Market size: TAM, SAM, SOM inputs

Status: pre-product. The product, scoup.ai, uses synthetic data only, has never been deployed and has no paying customers. Version 3, 2026-10-17: rebuilt for the owner's shipper- and importer-first strategy. Mid-market shippers and SME importers form the SAM; carriers are a separate later segment. Revenue per account is the finance model's (finance worktree: financial/assumptions.md, financial/unit-economics.md, financial/scenarios.md). Cross-checks that use other methods are labelled as such in section 5. No figure below is a forecast of our revenue, and none has been checked against a customer's closed files.

Research date: 2026-10-17. Every input carries a grade. - SOURCED-A: primary public data (regulator, statistical agency, SEC filing, our own query of a government dataset). - SOURCED-B: reputable third-party research or trade survey, read at or near the primary. - SOURCED-C: vendor or market-report claim; method not visible. - ASSUMED: our number; untested; must be replaced by pilot data.

1. Why the headline numbers are not the TAM

Three large numbers get quoted for this market, and none of them is revenue we could earn. ATRI's $15.1B is the cost of waiting, mostly lost productivity. The FMC's $15.4B is what ocean carriers collected over five years, most of it legitimately owed. The $883.2B trucking figure is all US truck spend. We keep them because they show scale, and we keep them out of the TAM because they describe the problem, not our addressable fee pool.

Input	Value	Grade	Source
Detention cost to US trucking, 2023	$15.1B ($3.6B direct expense + $11.5B lost productivity)	SOURCED-B	ATRI, released 10 Sept 2024
Share of stops with detention, 2023	39.3%	SOURCED-B	ATRI, same
Fleets that charge detention	94.5%	SOURCED-B	ATRI, same
Share of detention invoices paid	fewer than 50%	SOURCED-B	ATRI, same
US business logistics costs, 2025	$2.40T	SOURCED-B	CSCMP / Kearney 2026 State of Logistics
Trucking share of logistics spend, 2025	36.8%, so $883.2B (our arithmetic: 2.40T x 0.368)	SOURCED-B	same
Ocean D&D collected by nine largest carriers, Apr 2020 to Mar 2025	$15.4B, an average of $3.08B a year (our arithmetic: 15.4 / 5)	SOURCED-A	FMC
Freight audit and payment market size	conflicting: $284.5M (2024, SkyQuest via GII); $6.8B (2025, Market Intelo); +$651.2M growth 2026-2030 at 11.2% CAGR (Technavio)	SOURCED-C	report landing pages

Sources for the table: Source: American Transportation Research Institute, "New Research Documents Substantial Financial and Safety Impacts from Truck Driver Detention", https://truckingresearch.org/2024/09/new-research-documents-substantial-financial-and-safety-impacts-from-truck-driver-detention/, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: SCDigest, coverage of the 2026 CSCMP State of Logistics report, https://www.scdigest.com/firstthoughts/26-06-26.php?cid=23144, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Federal Maritime Commission, Detention and Demurrage, https://www.fmc.gov/detention-and-demurrage/, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: GII (SkyQuest), Freight Audit and Payment Market, https://www.giikorea.co.kr/report/sky1913174-freight-audit-payment-market-size-share-growth.html, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Market Intelo, Freight Audit and Payment Market Research Report 2034,

https://marketintelo.com/report/freight-audit-and-payment-market, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Technavio, Freight Audit and Payment Market, https://www.technavio.com/report/freight-audit-and-payment-market-industry-analysis, accessed 2026-10-17

Changes against figures already in the repo: - ATRI $15.1B: confirmed against the live ATRI release. The repo graded it B from trade press; we read ATRI's own release, so the components are now confirmed ($3.6B + $11.5B). - Freight audit market "~$3.1B, ~6.8% growth" (market-analysis.md): not reproduced. The live report pages we reached give $284.5M, $6.8B and a growth-only figure, a 24-fold spread between the two size estimates. The repo figure should be dropped from investor material; if a FAP market number is needed, cite the spread and say why it is unusable. - Trucking spend: the repo used no trucking-spend figure. The 2025 edition of State of Logistics put 2024 logistics at $2.58T; the 2026 edition restates 2024 at $2.43T and reports $2.40T for 2025. Use the 2026 edition.

2. Counts of buyers

Input	Value	Grade	Source
Active interstate for-hire carriers, all sizes	532,506	SOURCED-A	FMCSA Company Census File, our query
Same, 5 to 100 power units, MCS-150 updated since 17 Oct 2024	72,053 carriers, 1,206,250 power units (average 16.7)	SOURCED-A	same
Same, 5 to 100 power units, no recency filter	80,296	SOURCED-A	same
Same, 11 to 100 power units, recent filers	32,676	SOURCED-A	same
US importing companies, 2024	240,535 (234,023 SME, 6,512 large)	SOURCED-A	Census CB26-73
SME share of known import value, 2024	$884B of $2,926B = 30.2% (our arithmetic)	SOURCED-A	same
Active freight brokerage authorities, Jan 2024	28,438	SOURCED-B	Carrier Details / Brush Pass via FreightCaviar
US firms with $100M to $999.9M receipts in manufacturing, wholesale and retail, 2022	19,932 (manufacturing 5,971; wholesale 8,798; retail 5,163)	SOURCED-A	Census SUSB 2022, receipts-size classes
Transportation cost as a share of sales, average company	4.68%	SOURCED-B (2008)	Establish Inc. survey via DC Velocity
US shippers with $5M to $50M annual freight spend	19,932 (modelled: $5M / 4.68% = $106.8M to $50M / 4.68% = $1.068B, rounded to the $100M to $999.9M Census classes); 9,366 at 2% freight-to-sales, 35,349 at 10%	ASSUMED (built from the two rows above)	02-industries.md
Receipts of those 19,932 firms, 2022	$4,057.4B; estimated freight spend $4,057.4B x 4.68% = $189.9B; average $9.53M per firm	SOURCED-A receipts, ASSUMED ratio	Census SUSB 2022

Source: FMCSA, Company Census File (dataset az4n-8mr2), https://data.transportation.gov/resource/az4n-8mr2.json, accessed 2026-10-17 (query script: research/scripts/fmcsa_carrier_counts.sh) Source: U.S. Census Bureau, "A Profile of U.S. Importing and Exporting Companies, 2023-2024", 5 May 2026, https://www.census.gov/foreign-trade/Press-Release/edb/edbrel2024.pdf, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: FreightCaviar, 24 January 2024, https://freightcaviar.com/brush-pass-research-7-8-fewer-brokerages-than-a-year-ago, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Statistics of U.S. Businesses 2022, https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/susb/tables/2022/us_naicssector_large_rcptsize_2022.xlsx,

accessed 2026-10-17 (extraction: research/scripts/susb_shipper_counts.py) Source: DC Velocity, "Logistics costs and services 2008", https://www.dcvelocity.com/articles/31001-logistics-costs-and-services-2008, accessed 2026-10-17

The repo's market analysis said the carrier and shipper counts were "not sourced yet". Both are now filled: carriers from the FMCSA census file, shippers from a model built on Census revenue classes. The shipper figure is a modelled count, not a list of firms, and it moves a lot with the freight-to-sales ratio.

3. Revenue per account: the finance model's path

The investor package uses the finance model's revenue per account by segment. The table shows the importer path; the model sets a shipper at 77% of the importer's recovery (no ocean D&D), giving $27.6K in year 7, and a carrier at a flat $7,895 through a channel partner (financial/scenarios.md). Section 5 tests whether these fit each segment.

Input	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5	Y6	Y7	Status
Platform fee ($K)	0	6	10	13	15	16	17	ASSUMED (finance input "fee")
Amount recovered for the customer ($K)	52	70	85	95	105	110	115	ASSUMED (finance input "recov")
Recovery share	25%	17%	14%	12%	12%	12%	12%	ASSUMED (finance input "share")
Revenue per account, importer, base ($K)	13.0	17.9	21.9	24.4	27.6	29.2	30.8	model output
Revenue per account, shipper, base ($K)	10.0	15.2	19.2	21.8	24.7	26.2	27.6	model output
Revenue per account, carrier via partner ($K)	7.9	7.9	7.9	7.9	7.9	7.9	7.9	model output

Revenue per account = platform fee + amount recovered x recovery share. Year 3: $10.0K + $85K x 14% = $21.9K. The year-1 recovery of $52K is the business case's mid-size importer-shipper ($36K of non-compliant D&D on a $240K exposure, plus $16K of fuel-surcharge overbilling). Bull is 1.15x base and bear 0.8x (finance input "rmult"). Source: finance worktree, financial/assumptions.md (inputs fee, recov, share, rmult), financial/unit-economics.md and financial/scenarios.md, dated 2026-10-17

4. TAM, SAM, SOM (the package numbers)

Definitions. SAM is the core market under the shipper- and importer-first strategy: mid-market shippers plus the SME importers the D&D pool can support. TAM adds the segments we would serve later or have not tested: carriers and brokers. SOM is the finance base case. Every figure uses the finance model's year-7 revenue per account for its segment (financial/scenarios.md): shipper $27.6K, SME importer $30.8K, carrier $7.9K ($7,895, through a channel partner). The model has no broker segment; for brokers we use $12,000 a year, ASSUMED; derived from a superseded price path (the business plan's old phase-2 platform fee of $1,000 a month); finance's model has no broker segment.

Segment	Accounts	Year-7 revenue per account	Annual revenue at 100%	In
Mid-market shippers ($5M to $50M freight spend)	19,932	$27.6K	$550.1M	SAM core
SME ocean importers, capped by the FMC D&D pool	12,833	$30.8K	$395.3M	SAM core
SAM	**32,765**		**$945.4M**	
Carriers, 5 to 100 power units (later, partner channel)	72,053	$7.9K	$568.9M	TAM only
Freight brokers (no evidence yet that they buy)	28,438	$12.0K (ASSUMED; derived from a superseded price path; finance's model has no broker segment)	$341.3M	TAM only

Segment	Accounts	Year-7 revenue per account	Annual revenue at 100%	In
TAM	**133,256**		**$1,855.5M**	

Arithmetic: 19,932 x $27.6K = $550.1M; 12,833 x $30.8K = $395.3M; SAM = $945.4M. 72,053 x $7,895 = $568.9M; 28,438 x $12,000 = $341.3M; TAM = $945.4M + $568.9M + $341.3M = $1,855.5M.

- **SAM: $945.4M a year** (32,765 accounts). The two core groups overlap by an unknown amount, because some mid-size wholesalers and manufacturers also import by container. If every capped importer were also in the shipper count, SAM would fall to 19,932 accounts and $550.1M. We report the range $0.55B to $0.95B.
- **TAM: $1.86B a year** (133,256 accounts). Counting all 234,023 SME importers instead of the 12,833 cap would add 221,190 accounts at $30.8K, a further $6.81B; section 5.2 explains why we do not.
- **SOM: the finance base case (segment-split model).** Year 7: 805 accounts and $16.91M revenue ($19.25M year-end ARR). Of these, 605 are direct accounts in the SAM (304 mid-market shippers and 301 SME importers, $15.58M revenue) and 200 are carriers won through a channel partner ($1.33M), which count against the carrier segment, not the SAM. Year 5: 412 accounts (165 shippers, 163 importers, 84 carriers) and $7.44M revenue. Bull year 7: 1,221 accounts (424 shippers, 423 importers, 374 carriers) and $27.92M.
- **Shares, year 7 base:** direct accounts 605 / 32,765 = 1.8% of SAM accounts (bull 847 = 2.6%); shippers 304 / 19,932 = 1.5%; importers 301 / 12,833 = 2.3%; carriers 200 / 72,053 = 0.3% of the carrier segment. By revenue: direct $15.58M / $945.4M = 1.6% of SAM; shippers $7.40M / $550.1M = 1.3%; importers $8.18M / $395.3M = 2.1%; carriers $1.33M / $568.9M = 0.2%; total $16.91M / $1,855.5M = 0.9% of TAM. Source: finance worktree, financial/scenarios.md, base and bull case tables, dated 2026-10-17

Alignment with finance: the model uses 32,765 SAM accounts and 133,256 TAM accounts and the same segment rates (financial/scenarios.md, section "Market size and share of SAM"). The 12,833 capped importers are the mid-size importers the model's importer revenue path assumes (about $36K of D&D recovery each; see 02-industries.md, "Importers by size").

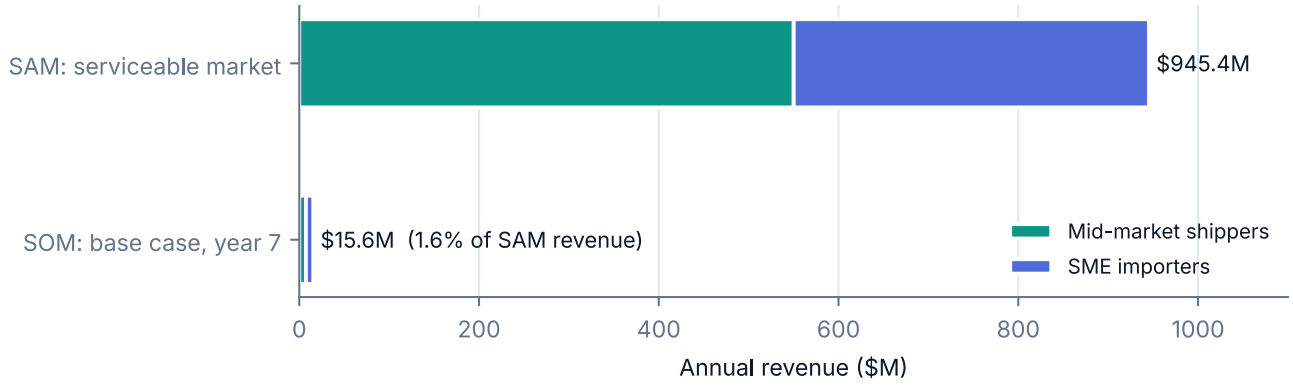


Figure 2: Serviceable market (SAM) against obtainable base-case revenue in year 7 (SOM), split by core segment. Source: research/05-market-size.md § 4. TAM, SAM, SOM; SOM from financial/tools/verify_results.json § base, checked against the same section

5. Cross-checks (separate methods, not package numbers)

5.1 Shippers: does the model's recovery path fit?

Average freight spend in the shipper band is $9.53M (section 2). At 1% recoverable unsupported accessorials and errors (ASSUMED; audit vendors claim 1% to 9%, grade C), a typical shipper recovers $95.3K a year. The model's recovery path runs from $52K (year 1) to $115K (year 7), so the shipper cross-check lands inside it. At the ends of the band the fit breaks: a $5M-spend shipper recovers $50K and a $50M-spend shipper $500K at the same 1%.

5.2 Importers: the FMC D&D pool caps the count

At the model's $36K D&D recovery per account, all 234,023 SME importers would need $36K x 234,023 = $8.42B a year, 2.7 times the $3.08B the nine largest carriers collect in D&D a year (FMC, April 2020 to March 2025 average). If the whole pool were spread across accounts with the business case's $240K exposure, it would support $3.08B / $240K = 12,833 importer accounts. That is the cap used in the SAM. It is generous, since it assumes every D&D dollar sits with an importer of that size. Source: Federal Maritime Commission, Detention and Demurrage, https://www.fmc.gov/detention-and-demurrage/, accessed 2026-10-17

5.3 Carriers: detention-dollar bottom-up

Inputs: 400 stops per power unit per year (ASSUMED) x 39.3% detained (SOURCED-B, ATRI) x $100 billable per detained stop (ASSUMED; ATRI's 2019 average fee was $63.71 an hour) x 50% unpaid (SOURCED-B as a floor) x 30% winnable (ASSUMED) = $2,358 per power unit a year, or $39.5K per average carrier of 16.74 power units. At the model's year-3 terms that is $10.0K + 14% x $39.5K = $15.5K of revenue, 29% below the model's $21.9K. The finance model prices a partner-channel carrier at a flat $7,895 a year, which is this method's fee per average carrier at a 20% contingency ($39.5K recovered x 20%). The TAM carrier row uses that rate: 72,053 x $7,895 = $568.9M. Source for $63.71: J. J. Keller Compliance Network, 5 September 2019, https://jjkellercompliancenetwork.com/news/atri-driver-detention-frequency-length-on-the-rise, accessed 2026-10-17

5.4 Superseded figures

Earlier versions of this file were sent on 2026-10-17 and are withdrawn. Version 1: TAM excluding shippers $971.8M, SAM $474.2M, year-5 SOM $14.6M (20% fee, $40,000 shipper contract). Version 2: TAM $10.30B, SAM $8.99B (carriers plus all SME importers), capped SAM $2.17B, on 334,514 accounts that excluded shippers. Neither should appear in the package. Version 3 as first sent applied a flat $30.8K to every segment: SAM $1.01B (range $0.61B to $1.01B), TAM $4.10B (carriers $2,219.2M, brokers $875.9M at $30.8K). It was replaced on 2026-10-17 by the segment rates above so that market size and the finance model agree; the flat figures are superseded.

6. What would change these numbers most

Four inputs drive the package numbers, and all four are assumed or dated. The freight-to-sales ratio behind the shipper count comes from a 2008 survey; a purchased firmographic list filtered by revenue and industry, or a current Establish figure, would replace it. The amount recovered per account and the fee path can only come from design partners' closed files. The overlap between mid-market shippers and SME importers decides where SAM falls between $0.55B and $0.95B, and an import-records dataset matched to firm size would settle it. Carriers matter for TAM only, and their own cross-check says the model path overstates them.

Open questions

Status: pre-product. The product, scoup.ai, uses synthetic data only, never deployed, no paying customers. This file lists every figure we could not source and every URL we could not reach during the 2026-10-17 research pass, so the next pass (or a paid data purchase) can close them. Nothing here was replaced with a guess.

UNKNOWN values (needs primary research)

#	Question	Where it is used	Suggested route
1	How many US shippers have $5M to $50M annual freight spend? Now MODELLED at 19,932 (Census SUSB 2022 revenue classes x Establish 2008 freight-to-sales ratio of 4.68%); 9,366 at 2%, 35,349 at 10%. Needs a current ratio or a direct count	02, 05 (SAM core)	Buy a firmographic list (D&B, ZoomInfo) filtered by industry and revenue; request a current Establish logistics-cost figure
2	How many US importers move goods by ocean container, and how many are SMEs?	02 (importers)	Census importer data by mode is not in the public profile; try USA Trade Online or a bill-of-lading dataset
3	Does the FMC's $15.4B D&D figure cover US trades only?	02, 05	Ask FMC or read the underlying data notes on the FMC D&D page
4	What share of unpaid detention is winnable with an evidence packet? (assumed 30%)	02, 05	Design-partner closed files; this is the business plan's G1 milestone
5	What share of mid-market shipper spend is recoverable unsupported accessorials? (assumed 1%)	02, 05	Design-partner closed files
6	What share of D&D charges is recoverable through a dispute? (assumed 10%)	02, 05	Importer pilot; also try to open the FMC docket 22-04 comments that cite a 30% to 40% inaccuracy rate
7	What contingency rate do competitors charge, if any? (assumed 20%)	02, 05	Sales calls or buyer interviews; no competitor publishes one
8	Current billable detention per detained stop (assumed $100; newest public fee figure is ATRI's 2019 average of $63.71 an hour)	05	ATRI's 2024 full report (purchase or request), or carrier interviews
9	Stops per power unit per year (assumed 400)	02, 05	ATRI operational cost report, or ELD data from a design partner
10	Freight brokerage gross revenue and a 2025-2026 broker count	02 (brokers)	FMCSA Licensing and Insurance data; TIA reports
11	Trax founding year	01	Trax press kit or LinkedIn
12	Hey Bubba founding year, HQ and funding	01	Company contact, Crunchbase
13	FleetOptos / Calcutiv LLC founding year and HQ	01	Company contact, state business registry
14	Pricing for every profiled competitor	01, 03	Not public for any of the nine; requires sales conversations or buyer interviews
15	An independent shipper survey on accessorial and FSC overcharge rates (partly answered 2026-10-17: RXO 2024 survey of 750 shippers and carriers covers workload and attitudes, not overcharge rates; CSCMP, Gartner, ARC, APQC and NASSTRAC sources not found)	02, 04	Logistics Management, CSCMP, or Gartner research; the Transplace study page was unreachable (see below)
16	Outside demand evidence for four-eyes approval, fuel-surcharge outlook and charge prioritisation	04	Buyer interviews
17	Average power units of the 57,712 general-freight carriers (we used the 5 to 100 band average of 16.74)	05	Re-run the FMCSA query with the general-freight filter and avg(power_units)
18	Size of the freight audit and payment market (repo figure ~$3.1B not reproduced; live estimates span $284.5M to $6.8B)	05	Do not use until a method-transparent source is found

#	Question	Where it is used	Suggested route
19	Current transportation-cost-to-sales ratio for mid-size manufacturers, wholesalers and retailers (we use Establish 2008, 4.68%; a 2014 figure of 4.43% appears only in a slide deck we could not open)	02, 05	Establish Inc. current report; Tompkins Supply Chain Consortium
20	Overlap between the 19,932 mid-market shippers and the SME importers	05 (SAM range $0.55B to $0.95B)	Match import records (bill-of-lading data) to firm size
21	Prices of Intelligent Audit Catalyst's three plans	01	Sign up for the free trial or ask sales
22	Whether forwarders or customs brokers sell priced D&D recovery services	01	Calls to five to ten mid-size forwarders and brokers
23	Data2Logistics customer mix by size (CB Insights summary says large to small and medium-sized)	01	Open the CB Insights or PitchBook profile
24	Number of US importers bringing in 500 to 5,000 TEU a year (public bound 4,160 to 20,279; FMC-pool cap 12,833 used)	02, 05, finance	Buy bill-of-lading data (PIERS, ImportGenius, Descartes Datamyne) and count consignees by annual TEU

Not re-verified this session

- project44, FourKites and TMS-embedded audit (Oracle, Blue Yonder, MercuryGate) as adjacent competitors or partners. Carried over from the repo's market analysis.
- Cass Q1 2025 ($8.6B) and Q4 2025 ($9.2B) transportation dollar volumes came from search-indexed copies of the releases; the Q2 and Q3 figures were read from SEC EDGAR. Re-read Q1 and Q4 from EDGAR before use.
- Loop's Series C was confirmed through AlphaMaven and Sacra, not through a Loop or Valor press release.
- Census SME manufacturer (39,214) and wholesaler (86,789) importer counts were read from chart labels in the release PDF, not from a data table.

Names in the brief we could not verify or dropped

- "Fenix Parcel": no verifiable company found under that name. Parcel refund auditing is outside our wedge.
- Kpler: a commodity and maritime data company; no evidence it sells D&D invoice auditing. Dropped.
- Portcast: real and relevant, but kept in the adjacent list because pricing, customers and dispute volumes could not be confirmed.

Unreachable URLs (attempted 2026-10-17)

URL	Result	What we wanted
https://www.fmcsa.dot.gov/sites/fmcsa.dot.gov/files/2025-09/FMCSA%20Pocket%20Guide%202024-v6%20508%20.pdf	HTTP 403 (curl returned an HTML block page)	Carrier counts by fleet size; replaced by our own query of the FMCSA census file
https://ai.fmcsa.dot.gov/registrationstatistics	HTTP 403	Registration statistics
https://www.cts.umn.edu/sites/cts.umn.edu/files/2025-04/dan_murray_atri_trucking_101_v3.pdf	HTTP 403	ATRI fleet-size and industry figures
https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260122966914/en	HTTP 403	Cass Q4 2025 results
https://www2.fmc.gov/readingroom/docs/22-04/22-04_Comments_USA_Rice.pdf/	HTTP 403	Primary shipper comment on D&D dispute burden

URL	Result	What we wanted
https://www.supplychain247.com/article/transplace_study_takes_deep_dive_into_various_accessorial_charges_for_shipp	HTTP 403	Transplace accessorial study
https://loop.com/pricing	HTTP 404	Loop pricing
https://www.portcast.io/pricing	HTTP 404	Portcast pricing
https://bubba.ai/pricing	HTTP 404	Hey Bubba pricing
https://api.census.gov/data/2022/cbp	redirect to "Missing Key" page	Establishment counts by size for manufacturing and wholesale
https://www.inboundlogistics.com/articles/allen-company-selects-nvision-global/	no readable text returned by curl	Evidence of nVision mid-size customers
https://dhl.com/content/dam/dhl/local/us/dhl-global-forwarding/documents/pdf/us-dgf-fmc-dds-mitigation.pdf	file did not parse as PDF text	DHL D&D dispute service details
https://cassinfo.com/freight-audit-payment	reachable, but content is rendered by JavaScript; raw HTML had no figures	Cass scale figures; we used the SEC filings instead

Method tried and rejected

The BEA 2023 summary use table (https://apps.bea.gov/industry/iTables%20Static%20Files/AllTablesSUP.zip) was tested as a source for freight cost as a share of output. In its purchasers'-price framework, freight on purchased goods is folded into the goods rows, so truck transportation shows as 0.03% of manufacturing output. That reflects the accounting convention, not shippers' freight bills, so we did not use it. The files are kept outside the repo, in the session scratchpad.

Research-quality note

One page-summary result was discarded. A fetch of the Surface Transportation Board notice of 16 April 2019 (https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/FR-2019-04-16/pdf/2019-07522.pdf) returned a quotation that does not appear in the document when we extracted its text. We removed it and checked every quotation in 02 and 04 against raw page text. Figures marked "(vendor page)" in 01 were read through a summarizing fetch and should be spot-checked against the live page before publication.